FX Technical Update

The broad dollar can see more short-term consolidation within an intact medium-term bull trend

- EUR/USD consolidates the Sep-Nov bear trend below key short-term resistance near 1.06. We think the pair is vulnerable to a bearish extension in the first quarter, but expect further consolidation first and see risk for a position squeeze with a break above 1.06 pattern resistance.
- The initial GBP/USD rebound from the 1.2486 Nov low rejected key short-term resistance just above 1.28 that includes the post-election breakdown, Sep 38.2% retrace, and cluster of moving averages. We expect more short-term range trading in the weeks ahead and mostly below that key chart inflection.
- USD/JPY tracks the DM backup to higher yields. We think this tactical bounce is running out of room and likely to fade soon. Nearby Fibonacci retracement resistance levels rest at 153.795-155.0165. Medium-term resistance rests at 156.75-157.23.
- AUD/USD remains on a bearish slippery slope after repeated failed attempts to decelerate the Sep-Dec slide. Now in the lower-end of the 2023-2024 trading range, we will stay on the lookout for a more substantial base pattern formation and signs the pair has finally found solid ground. Key trend resistance now rests at 0.6463-0.645.

Technical Strategy

Jason Hunter AC
(1-212) 270-0034
jason.x.hunter@jpmorgan.com
J.P. Morgan Securities LLC

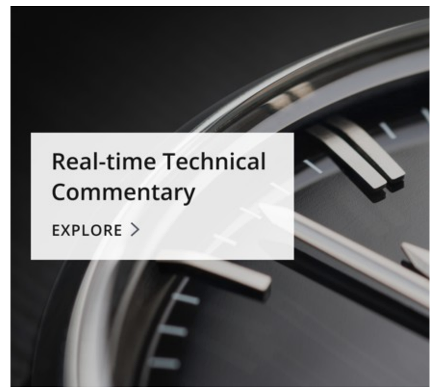
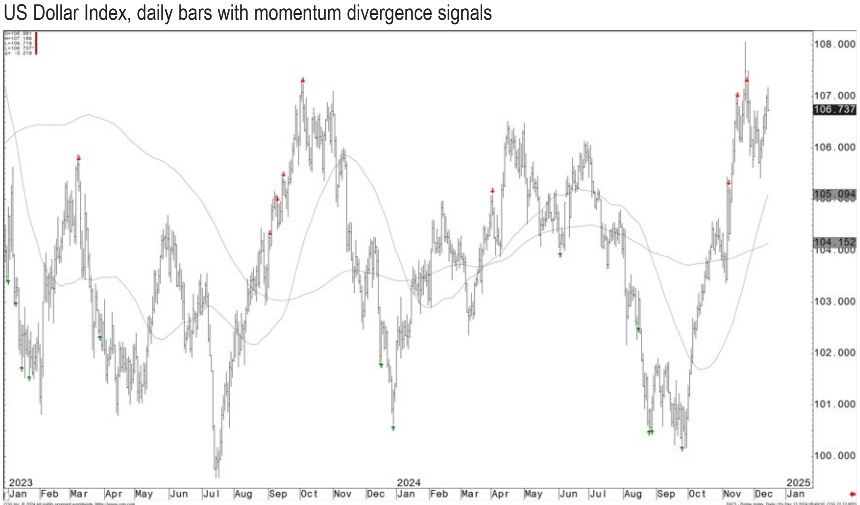


Figure 1: The US dollar continues to consolidate after the Sep-Nov bull trend traversed the full breadth of the 2023-2024 trading range. We suspect the market can consolidate further into early-2025, but the bullish medium-term trend dynamics stay in place and suggest further bullish pressure thereafter

US Dollar Index, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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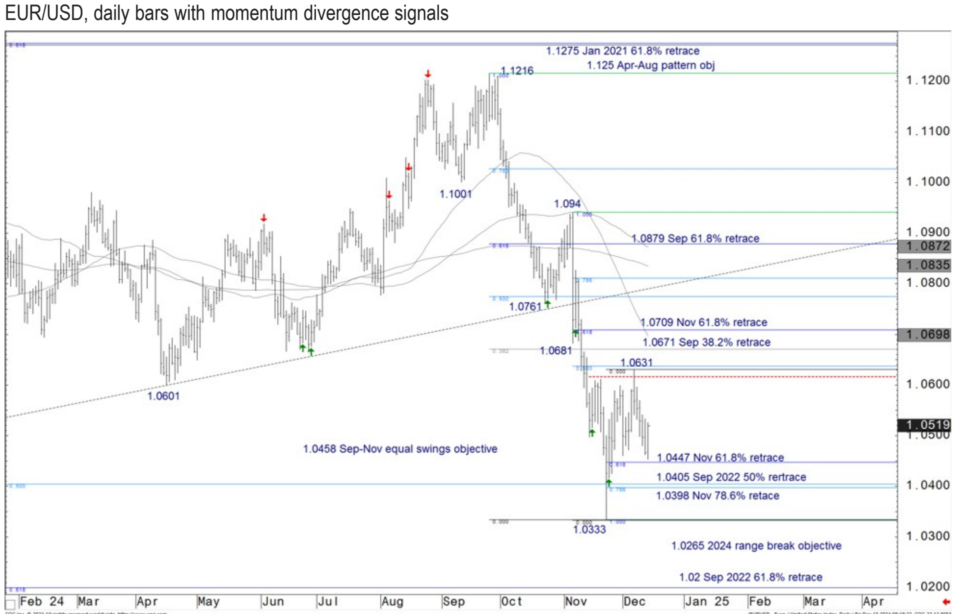
Jason Hunter [AC]
(1-212) 270-0034
jason.x.hunter@jpmorgan.com

Look for more EUR/USD consolidation after the Sep-Nov slide

After finally finding some solid ground on the heels of the weakness into and then after the Nov US election, **EUR/USD** has consolidated in a fairly tight range below key pattern resistance that sits just above 1.06 (Figure 2). We expect more consolidation into early next year as the market continues to work of the oversold conditions generated by the recent slide. Sentiment has improved some, but still sits at low levels. For example, the Daily Sentiment Index for the Euro futures have risen from sub-10% bulls to near 30% bulls (source: Network Press, Inc., www.trade-futures.com). Given that still oversold condition and what appears to be a potential head and shoulders pattern now present on the chart with the 1.0601-1.0631 recent highs as the neckline, we are mindful that a move through that area can trigger a short-lived position squeeze. Fibonacci retracement resistance levels sit overhead at 1.0671 and 1.0709, but we don't see meaningful price pattern resistance until near 1.08. That importantly marks the post-election pattern and trend line breakdown levels, an area we think leaves a ceiling over the pair in the months ahead. As a result, a squeeze into that resistance would provide an optimal opportunity to enter bearish risk. On the downside, nearby support rests at the 1.0447 Nov 61.8% retrace, 1.0405 Sep 2022 50% retrace, and 1.0398 Nov 78.6% retrace. Longer-term support sits at the 1.0265 2024 pattern breakdown objective and 1.02 Sep 2022 61.8% retrace, levels we think the pair can test at some point in the early months of next year.

Figure 2: EUR/USD consolidates the Sep-Nov bear trend below key short-term resistance near 1.06. We think the pair is vulnerable to a bearish extension in the first quarter, but expect further consolidation first and see risk for a position squeeze with a break above 1.06 pattern resistance.

EUR/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

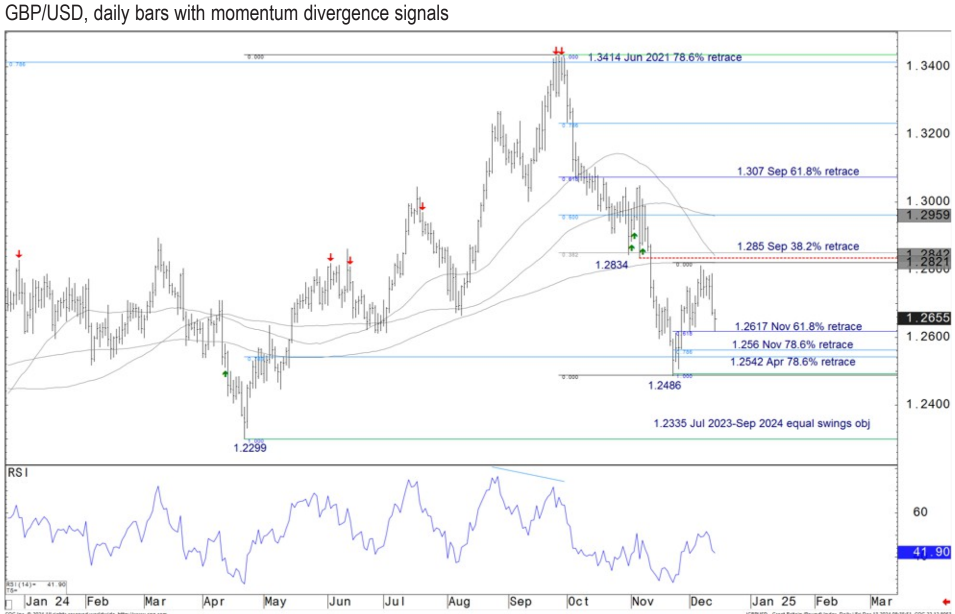
Jason Hunter [AC]
(1-212) 270-0034
jason.x.hunter@jpmorgan.com

GBP/USD looks set for more range trading below key levels that sit just above 1.28

Cable slips back from key resistance at the 1.282 200-day moving average, 1.2834 early-Nov low, 1.2842 50-day moving average, and 1.285 Sep 38.2% retrace after the initial bounce from the 1.2486 Nov low faded (Figure 3). We think the market can consolidate further to work off more of the oversold conditions generated by the Sep-Nov slide, but the absence of medium-term signals that would indicate a bottom is in place leave us looking for further weakness early next year. Look for most of that consolidation to play out below the resistance noted above. Nearby support sits at the 1.2617 Nov 61.8% retrace, 1.256 Nov 78.6% retrace and 1.2542 Apr 78.6% retrace. We think the pair can extend to the 1.2335 Jul 2023-Sep 2024 equal swings objective and 1.2299 Apr low in the early months of next year. Alternatively, a break above 1.285 would turn our attention to the higher Sep Fibonacci retracement levels, at 1.296 and 1.307.

Figure 3: The initial GBP/USD rebound from the 1.2486 Nov low rejected key short-term resistance just above 1.28 that includes the post-election breakdown, Sep 38.2% retrace, and cluster of moving averages. We expect more short-term range trading in the weeks ahead and mostly below that key chart inflection.

GBP/USD, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

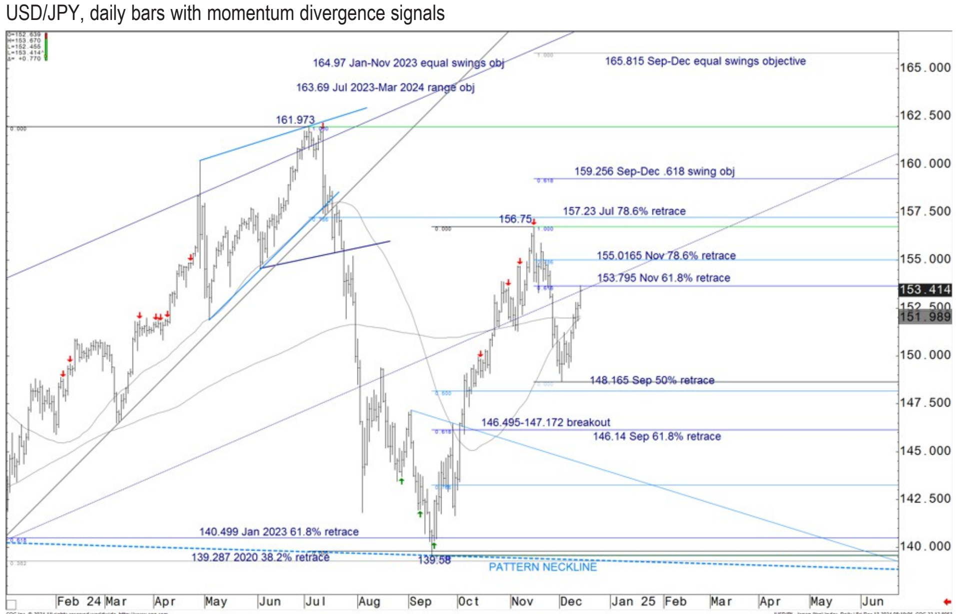
Jason Hunter AC
(1-212) 270-0034
jason.x.hunter@jpmorgan.com

USD/JPY tracks DM yields to higher levels; watch for that tactical move to fade soon

USD/JPY rebounds as DM bond yields retrace the Nov-Dec rallies. We suspect both of those near-term moves will fade soon, with USD/JPY now into the 153.795 Nov 61.8% retrace (Figure 4). Other short-term resistance includes the 155.0165 Nov 78.6% retrace. The 156.75 Nov peak overshot the Apr-Jul pattern breakdown levels in the 155-handles, but faded near the 157.23 Jul 78.6% retrace. Look for that zone to cap the pair into next year. On the downside, tactical bulls would fumble with a move below the 151.99 moving average confluence. The Dec low held the 148.165 Sep 50% retrace. We think the pair will retrace that level and potential slide to medium-term support at the 146.14-147.172 Aug-Sep pattern breakout area and Sep 61.8% retrace in the early months of next year.

Figure 4: USD/JPY tracks the DM backup to higher yields. We think this tactical bounce is running out of room and likely to fade soon. Nearby Fibonacci retracement resistance levels rest at 153.795-155.0165. Medium-term resistance rests at 156.75-157.23.

USD/JPY, daily bars with momentum divergence signals



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Jason Hunter AC
(1-212) 270-0034
jason.x.hunter@jpmorgan.com

AUD/USD struggles to find solid ground in the lower end of the 2023-2024 trading range

On the heels of the Sep-Oct weakness, **AUD/USD** was already showing tentative signs of trying to find some footing heading into the US election. The pair has been on a bearish slippery slope ever since, with repeated momentum divergence signals and attempts to tactically base that were followed by persistent weakness. That rinse-and-repeat sequence now leaves the pair in the lower end of the broad 2023-2024 trading range. Repeated momentum divergence signals point to trend deceleration, but after the failed sequence of those signals, its hard to have conviction that the market is truly trying to bottom here at the moment (Figure 5). We need to see clearer signs of a base pattern, which is to say sideways price action for a few weeks and an inability to extend much below the 0.6369 2022-2024 trend line or 0.6349 Aug panic trough. Longer-term support sits at the 0.6269 Oct 2022 low, 0.626 Sep-Nov equal swings objective, and 0.623 Sep channel. On the upside, key short-term trend resistance rests at the 0.6463 Nov pattern low and 0.645 Sep channel trend line. An upside break would set the market up for a broader retracement and a potential test of the 0.6551 Nov consolidation pattern high and moving averages clustered above.

Figure 5: AUD/USD remains on a bearish slippery slope after repeated failed attempts to decelerate the Sep-Dec slide. Now in the lower-end of the 2023-2024 trading range, we will stay on the lookout for a more substantial base pattern formation and signs the pair has finally found solid ground. Key trend resistance now rests at 0.6463-0.645.

AUD/USD daily bars with momentum divergence signals

Source: J.P. Morgan, CQG

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Jason Hunter AC
(1-212) 270-0034
jason.x.hunter@jpmorgan.com

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